

HASHKAMA WEEKLY



פרשת נשא

יג' סיון תשפ"ו

MAY 29, 2026

VOL 5786 ISSUE 35

By Reb Gemini חכמה ב-א תאמין?

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini:
Did the AI get it right?

it to be accurate?

Do you find

Or did the technology miss the boat?

Ah gutten Shabbos! If there is one thing a Litvish shul understands better than anyone, it is the sacred art of the building campaign, an endeavor requiring more siyata dishmaya than Kriyas Yam Suf. In Parshas Naso, we see the original building fund for the Mishkan. The Nesi'im arrive with a tremendous donation: six eglos tzav and twelve bekar for the Leviim to transport the Mishkan. Rashi (Bamidbar 7:3), quoting the Midrash Tanchuma, points out the math: there was one eglah for every two Nesi'im. Imagine two prominent balabatim sharing a single dedication plaque on the new aron kodesh, or worse, sharing a reserved parking spot. It requires massive vatranus. The Sifsei Chachamim (Bamidbar 7:3) explains that they partnered together because a single Nasi giving a whole wagon would have been too boastful, or perhaps they simply wanted to split the zechus. The Gershuni and Merari families received these eglos, while the Kehasi family carried their load on their shoulders. We see here the shtikel greatness of the Nesi'im: they understood that true avodas Hashem sometimes means swallowing your pride and splitting the steering wheel of the eglah with the mispallel who always takes your favorite makom kavua. It takes true midos to pool resources for the klal without demanding your own individual spotlight. Yet, right after this beautiful display of shared infrastructure, the Nesi'im suddenly switch their approach, bringing us to a gevaldig shift in the parsha. When it comes to the chanukas hamizbeach, each Nasi brings his own individual korban. The Torah (Bamidbar 7:12-83) spends seventy-one pesukim repeating the exact same silver kearah, silver mizrak, and golden kaf twelve different times! It reads like the Gabbai announcing weekly kugel sponsors, refusing to group them together to save time. Why not just write "and the other eleven Nesi'im brought the same thing"? The Ramban (Bamidbar 7:2) explains that although the physical items were identical, each Nasi had his own unique kavanah based on the specific shevet he represented. The Nasi of Yissachar thought of Torah, while Zevulun focused on parnassah. Their ruchniyus was entirely individualized! The Ohr HaChaim (Bamidbar 7:11) adds that Hashem wanted to give each Nasi his own kavod and separate day to shine. We share the eglos for the physical burden, but we bring our own kearah for the spiritual connection. Even if your tefillah looks exactly like the tefillah of the guy swaying frantically next to you, your internal kavanah is uniquely yours, even if he did steal your siddur. The **practical takeaway** here is a crucial lesson in how to function within a kehillah. When it comes to the gashmiyus of the shul — paying the electric bill or funding the Kiddush — we must act like the Nesi'im with the eglos: partner up, share the burden, and stop worrying about whose name is printed in a larger font on the weekly bulletin. But when it comes to your ruchniyus — your davening, your limud haTorah, your midos — you must bring your own individual korban. You cannot ride on the spiritual coattails of your chavrusa, even if his geshmak is very impressive. You need your own kavanah. May we all be zoche to share the eglos peacefully, bring our own kavanah to the Mishkan, and somehow survive the Gabbai's announcements before the cholent gets cold! Gut Shabbos!

News & Simchos!

Mazel Tov

To the Edelstein Family
on the birth of a baby girl
Fancy Kiddush After Davening

All Previous Newsletters are
available to download at:
archive.bm715.vip

Exciting Opportunity!

If you'd like to light up our lives with a
sponsorship or add some flavor
with a kiddush sponsorship, please

contact Tzvi Zev Rubin:

845-252-1260



Drasha Duty!

To give the Short Shiur after davening,
please contact Rabbi Genack:

646-413-5551



Sponsorship

נר למאור חודש סיון

Sponsored by

Thou Shall Not Be Named

In honor of Tzvi Zev Rubin
Who fixed our internet!



Shabbus Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm	מנחה
6:47/8:02 pm	הדלקה (Early/Late)
--:-- pm	מנחה - קבלת שבת
8:20 pm	שקיעה
3:41/4:15 am	עלות השחר (16.1/72)
5:27 am	נץ החמה
7:15 am	שחרית
Hot kiddush & Shiur after davening	
8:35/9:11 am	סיור קריאת שמע
10:01/10:25 am	סיור תפילה
12:54 pm	חצות היום
1:31 pm	מנחה גדולה (גר"א)
5:15 pm	מנחה קטנה (גר"א)
6:48 pm	פלג המנחה (גר"א)
--:-- pm	מנחה
8:21 pm	שקיעה
9:11/9:11 pm	צה"כ ר' משה (8.5/50)
9:13 pm	מעריב (52)
9:21/9:33 pm	צה"כ (60/72)



Next Week's Zmanim

Chestnut Ridge, NY

2:30 pm	מנחה
6:52/8:07 pm	הדלקה (Early/Late)
8:25 pm	שקיעה
7:15 am	שחרית
8:26 pm	שקיעה
9:18 pm	מעריב (52)

This Week's Riddle

Riddle: In this parsha, which two sons of Yaakov are not mentioned in the context of the Karbanos of the tribal leaders?

Answer: Yosef is not mentioned since his tribe is split into the tribes of Ephraim and Menashe. Levi is not mentioned because his tribal leader did not bring an offering in this parsha.



Donations & Payments

Zelle: Send to 845-252-1260

Check: Write Out to Bais Midrash 715

Cash: Hand to Tzvi Zev or Adam Edelstein

Credit Card: Visit the link cc.bm715.vip

Gift Card/Bitcoin: Do we look like Indian Scammers to you?

משל ונמשל ב-א' תאמין? By Reb Gemini

Consider the following "Torah" thought, generated by Gemini: Did the AI get it right? Do you find it to be accurate? Or did the technology miss the boat?

Mashal: Ah gutten Shabbos! The Dubno Maggid brings a gevaldig mashal about a famously wealthy gvir named Reb Getzel, who was known to have the deepest pockets but the sourest panim in town. Reb Getzel donated immense sums to the local Yeshiva, funding the Bais Medrash electricity bills, the yungeleit stipends, and the industrial vats of Thursday night cholent. Yet, whenever he handed his check to the Rosh Yeshiva, he did so with a severe scowl, complaining about the bochurim talking during chazaras hashatz, the angle of the shtenders, and the temperature of the mikvah. The yungeleit appreciated the gashmiyus, but they hid in the ezras nashim whenever Reb Getzel arrived. Conversely, Reb Feivel was a simple balabos who barely made parnassah selling shoelaces. He could only afford to sponsor a meager shalosh seudos once a year, consisting of stale crackers and one translucent herring. However, his panim shone like the urim v'tumim. He patted every bochur on the back, wishing them hatzlacha in their limud haTorah, and danced with them after Maariv. If you asked the bochurim who they felt supported by, they unanimously chose Reb Feivel. Reb Getzel provided the gashmiyus, but his demeanor made the tzedakah feel like a heavy burden. Reb Feivel gave with such ahavah that his stale crackers tasted like the mahn itself. A gift is not just about the tangible item; it depends entirely on the tzuras hapanim of the giver.

Nimshal: We find the exact nimshal to this dynamic in Parshas Naso, deeply embedded within the profound halachos of Birkas Kohanim. The Torah strictly instructs the Kohanim to bless the Yidden (Bamidbar 6:23). The Mishnah Berurah (128:37) codifies a truly staggering halacha: a Kohen must recite the bracha with complete ahavah. Furthermore, the Magen Avraham (Orach Chaim 128:18) clearly states that if the Kohen hates the tzibbur, or if the tzibbur harbors animosity toward the Kohen, he may not go up to the duchan at all! This requirement seems highly perplexing. Does the shefa actually originate from the Kohen himself? Absolutely not! The pasuk unequivocally concludes, "Va'ani avarcheim" (Bamidbar 6:27). Hashem distributes the parnassah, the shalom, and the brachos; the Kohen is merely the tzinor delivering the Heavenly mail! So why does it matter if the mailman is incredibly grumpy? The Kli Yakar (Bamidbar 6:23) profoundly explains that a bracha must be given with a "panim yafos." If the tzinor is completely clogged with machlokes, hakpadah, or a lack of ahavah, the spiritual shefa gets totally blocked. We see this explicitly in the Birkas Kohanim itself, where we declare: "Yaaer Hashem panav elecha" (Bamidbar 6:25). Rashi (Bamidbar 6:25) explains this means Hashem should display a radiant, smiling face. Hashem desires to bestow brachos upon us with a joyful smile, much like Reb Feivel serving his herring, rather than with Reb Getzel's reluctance. Therefore, the Kohen, functioning strictly as Hashem's emissary, must mirror that radiant ahavah. If the Kohen is frustrated because a guest took his makom kavua, he simply cannot channel the shefa.

Practical Takeaway: The practical takeaway for our own avodas Hashem is absolutely fundamental and applies constantly. Every single day, we have the tremendous zechus to do a chesed for another Yid, whether offering a ride to kollel, lending out an important sefer, or patiently listening to a close friend complain endlessly about his terrible shidduch resume. We must always remember that completing the technical action is only half the mitzvah. If you generously give your friend a ride to the shul but loudly sigh every time he adjusts the air conditioning vents, you are acting exactly like Reb Getzel. You successfully deliver the gashmiyus but you entirely ruin the bracha. The Rambam (Hilchos Matnos Aniym 10:4) explicitly states that anyone who gives tzedakah with a sour, grumpy face completely loses his merit, even if he magnanimously gave an absolute fortune! When we help a fellow Yid, we must do it b'ahavah, with a radiant panim yafos, actively ensuring our personal tzinor of chesed remains clear of any hidden hakpadah. May we all be zoche to constantly bless each other with true ahavah, to always receive Hashem's beautiful brachos with a shining face, and to successfully grab a piece of herring at shalosh seudos before the hungry bochurim finish it all! Gut Shabbos!

GOOD SHABBUS!